Rubric earn-out analysis in an acquisition

Criterion	Pass	Fail
Problem statement and structure	Explicit central question about the deal structure, logical progression from rationale through valuation and earn-out to sales and conclusion.	No central question, or only a summary of the case.
Strategic rationale	At least two well-supported reasons for the acquisition, a distinction between cost and revenue synergies, and the consequences of the integration approach.	General reasons without case data, or synergies not distinguished.
Valuation and deal structure	Purchase price assessed with a justified method, expected value of the earn-out calculated with probabilities and a justified discount rate.	Earn-out added at nominal value, no probability estimate, or a discount rate without justification ("customary" is not a justification).
Figure	Fully formatted and all values match the text and tables; the conclusion drawn from it is correct.	A value differs from the tables, or the conclusion drawn from the figure does not hold with the correct figures.
Earn-out: incentives and risks	Measure analysed, conflict of interest between founder and buyer linked to agency theory, dispute risks with appropriate safeguards, supported by literature on earn-outs.	Measure only described, no incentives or safeguards, or no literature.
Sales and integration: MEDDPICC	Applied to at least two concrete deals, with the change in the sales process caused by the acquisition and the consequences for the earn-out targets.	Only an explanation of the method, or no link to the earn-out.
Conclusion and recommendation	Answers the central question without new arguments, with a concrete recommendation and a limitation.	No answer, new arguments in the conclusion, or a vague recommendation.
Academic quality	At least four relevant sources in APA style, clear language, traceable calculations.	Too few sources, concepts misused, or results without calculation steps.